

2026 GLOBAL QUANTUM + AI CHALLENGE

Phase 1 Submission Guidelines

1. Overview

Phase 1 of the 2026 Global Quantum + AI Challenge is the Ideation Stage. Teams submit concept proposals responding to one or more enterprise problem statements published on the Challenge website. The objective is to identify innovative, feasible, and impactful approaches to real-world problems using quantum computing, quantum-inspired methods, or quantum-AI hybrid workflows.

Submissions are evaluated by a review panel comprising enterprise representatives, technical experts, and reviewers. A finalist cohort will be selected to advance to Phase 2 (the PoC Sprint).

2. Timeline

Guidance, subject to change.

Milestone	Date
Application window opens	April 2026 (at public launch)
Phase 1 submission deadline	15 Sep 2026
Review and shortlisting	16 Sep – 14 Nov 2026
Finalist notification	Mid-Nov 2026
Phase 2 PoC Sprint begins	Mid-Nov 2026

3. Eligibility

Submissions are invited from startups, research teams, universities, and industry teams worldwide. Teams may include individuals from multiple organizations. To be eligible:

- The team lead must be at least 18 years of age.

- The team lead must have accepted the Challenge Terms & Conditions at the point of submission.
- The proposal must respond to at least one published enterprise problem statement.
- The proposal must not contain confidential or proprietary information of any third party disclosed without permission.

Employees and Contractors of Resonance or its Challenge enterprise sponsors may not submit proposals as Participants.

4. What to Submit

Each submission must be made via the Challenge portal and must include the following components:

4.1 Team Profile

- Team name and lead contact details.
- Brief description of each team member (name, role, affiliation, relevant expertise).
- Indication of any prior experience with quantum computing, quantum-inspired methods, or the specific problem domain.

4.2 Problem Statement Selection

- Identify which enterprise problem statement(s) your proposal addresses.
- You may submit one proposal per problem statement. A team may submit to multiple problem statements, but each must be a separate submission.

4.3 Concept Proposal (max. 6 pages, PDF)

The concept proposal is the core of your submission. It should include:

1. Problem Framing: Your interpretation of the problem and why quantum or quantum-AI methods offer a credible advantage or novel insight.
2. Technical Approach: A clear description of the proposed method, algorithm, or workflow. Specify whether the approach is gate-based, variational, quantum-inspired, hybrid classical-quantum, or another paradigm.

3. **Feasibility and Resource Requirements:** An honest assessment of what is needed to demonstrate the approach (hardware, data, compute, software). Identify any assumptions or constraints.
4. **Expected Impact:** What would a successful PoC demonstrate? How would it advance the enterprise use case? Include any quantitative targets or benchmarks where possible.
5. **Validation Plan:** How you would test, measure, and validate your approach in a Phase 2 PoC sprint. What metrics would define success?
6. **Hybrid / Cross-Domain Integration (if applicable):** Describe how your approach integrates quantum methods with classical, HPC, or AI workflows, and the rationale for the hybrid design.
7. **Team Capability:** Why your team is well-positioned to execute this proposal.

4.4 Optional Supplementary Material

- Up to 3 additional pages of appendices (technical diagrams, references, prior work).
- A link to a public code repository (if relevant).

Do not include confidential or proprietary information in supplementary materials.

5. Formatting Requirements

- Concept proposal: maximum 6 pages (A4 or US Letter), PDF format, minimum 10pt font.
- Appendices: maximum 3 additional pages.
- All text must be in English.
- File size must not exceed 20 MB.
- Submissions exceeding the page limit may be returned or assessed only on the first 6 pages.

6. Selection Process

Phase 1 submissions are evaluated through a structured, multi-step process:

1. **Eligibility Screening:** Resonance confirms submissions meet format, timing, and scope requirements.

2. **Scored Review:** Each submission is evaluated against the Assessment Criteria (published separately).
3. **Technical Feasibility Input:** Technical reviewers assess the feasibility of the proposed approach and platform assumptions.
4. **Moderation and Ranking:** Scores are normalized and a moderation panel resolves outliers and finalizes the ranked list.
5. **Finalist Selection:** A finalist cohort is selected, sized for Phase 2 PoC capacity and compute availability.

All decisions are final. Resonance will notify all applicants of the outcome. Detailed reviewer feedback will not be provided, but summary feedback may be shared with finalists at Resonance's discretion.

7. Intellectual Property

All IP in your submission remains your property. By submitting, you grant Resonance a non-exclusive, royalty-free, worldwide license to use your submission for Challenge administration, evaluation, and judging, and to reference your team name, submission title, and a summary description in Challenge-related communications, marketing, press materials, and reports, as set out in the Challenge Terms & Conditions. Enterprise sponsors will have access to submissions for the purposes of evaluation, internal innovation assessment, and jury participation, on a non-exclusive, review-only basis. No ownership rights are transferred to any sponsor.

For full details, refer to Section 4 of the Terms & Conditions.

8. Tips for a Strong Submission

- **Be specific:** generic proposals that do not clearly address the enterprise problem statement will score poorly.
- **Be honest about feasibility:** reviewers value a realistic assessment of what can be demonstrated in a 3–4 month PoC sprint over ambitious claims without a credible path.
- **Show your working:** explain the technical approach clearly enough that a non-specialist reviewer can follow the logic, while providing enough depth for a specialist.
- **Define success:** a clear validation plan with measurable outcomes is one of the strongest differentiators.
- **Keep it tight:** a well-structured 4-page proposal will outperform a rambling 6-page one.

9. Questions and Support

For questions about the submission process, eligibility, or problem statements, please contact:

hello@resonance.holdings

All questions and answers, and any additional guidance will be published on the Challenge website. Resonance may host office hours or webinars during the submission window - details will be announced via the website and by email.